

HISTORY HACK · DOCUMENT-BASED QUESTION

DIRECTIONS: Analyze the three primary source excerpts below. Then write a response that constructs a historical argument answering the following question:

US.76 — Examine the roles and actions of civil rights advocates (e.g., Dr. Martin Luther King, Jr., Malcolm X, John Lewis, Diane Nash, Thurgood Marshall, Rosa Parks) and opponents (e.g., Bull Connor, Orval Faubus, George Wallace, Strom Thurmond). (T.C.A. § 49-6-1006)

US.79 — Analyze how the American Indian Movement, Chicano Movement, and Feminist Movement are related to the Civil Rights Movement in advancing equality across the broader spectrum of American society during this time period.

TEACHER EDITION — scoring guide and expected evidence. Not for student distribution.

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Directions. Analyze the three primary source excerpts below. Then write a response that constructs a historical argument answering the following question: How did the convergence of the anti-war movement, the Kent State killings, and the Watergate crisis between 1969 and 1974 together erode public trust in the federal government, and what evidence suggests these events marked a fundamental shift in American political culture rather than a temporary crisis? Your response must: - Analyze at least TWO of the three documents using the SOAPS framework (Speaker, Occasion, Audience, Purpose, Significance) - Synthesize evidence across documents to support a historical argument - Connect to your own knowledge of events and long-term consequences beyond the documents - Address standards US.79 and US.82

The sources

Document 1

'Report of the President's Commission on Campus Unrest' (Scranton Commission), Chapter 3: 'The Events at Kent State,' September 26, 1970. U.S. Government Printing Office. Washington, D.C. (Public domain U.S. government document.)

“The May 4 shootings at Kent State University are an event that divided Americans deeply. The Commission believes it necessary to speak plainly: the indiscriminate firing of rifles into a crowd of students and the deaths that followed were unnecessary, unwarranted, and inexcusable. The guardsmen on Blanket Hill, fearful and anxious, may have believed they were in danger, but they were not. The deaths of four students and the wounding of nine others must be condemned.”

SOURCE IT — DOCUMENT 1

H — Historical context

What was happening when this was made?

I — Intended audience

Who was meant to read or hear it?

P — Purpose

What was it trying to make the audience do or think?

P — Point of view

Who is speaking, and how does that shape it?

Document 2

Vietnam Veterans Against the War (VVAW), 'Statement of John Kerry,' testimony before the Senate Foreign Relations Committee, April 22, 1971. U.S. Senate Congressional Record, 92nd Congress, 1st Session. National Archives.

“We are here in Washington to say that the problem of this war is not just a question of war and diplomacy. It is part and parcel of everything that we are trying as human beings to communicate to people in this country — the question of racism, the question of a limited nuclear capability, the question of the use of this country as a tool to maintain a façade of democracy while actually it is run by a little group of men who make most of the decisions... We are also here to ask, and we are here to ask vehemently, where are the leaders of our country? Where is the leadership?”

SOURCE IT — DOCUMENT 2

H — Historical context

What was happening when this was made?

I — Intended audience

Who was meant to read or hear it?

P — Purpose

What was it trying to make the audience do or think?

P — Point of view

Who is speaking, and how does that shape it?

Document 3

President Richard Nixon, 'Address to the Nation Announcing His Resignation,' August 8, 1974. Public Papers of the Presidents of the United States. National Archives and Records Administration.

“I have never been a quitter. To leave office before my term is completed is abhorrent to every instinct in my body. But as President, I must put the interests of America first... I have always tried to do what was best for the Nation. Throughout the long and difficult period of Watergate, I have felt it was my duty to persevere, to make every possible effort to complete the term of office to which you elected me. In the past few days, however, it has become evident to me that I no longer have a strong enough political base in the Congress to continue that effort... Therefore, I shall resign the Presidency effective at noon tomorrow.”

SOURCE IT — DOCUMENT 3

H — Historical context

What was happening when this was made?

I — Intended audience

Who was meant to read or hear it?

P — Purpose

What was it trying to make the audience do or think?

P — Point of view

Who is speaking, and how does that shape it?

The question

Use SOAPS to analyze the documents, then construct your argument in 2-3 paragraphs.

Plan your answer

Your claim	
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Source	Evidence you will use	Why it supports your claim
Document 1		
Document 2		
Document 3		
Outside knowledge		

Write your response

Scoring guide

Pts	6-point scale
6	Exemplary. Constructs a defensible historical argument that directly addresses the prompt across US.79 and US.82. Analyzes all three documents using SOAPS accurately — speaker, occasion, audience, purpose, and significance are correctly identified for each and used analytically (not just listed). Synthesizes across documents to show cumulative erosion of trust. Integrates substantial outside knowledge (Gallup polling data, Church Committee, FECA 1974, Freedom of Information Act, or specific examples of institutional reform). Writing is clear, organized, and sustained across 2–3 paragraphs.
5	Advanced. Constructs a defensible argument. Analyzes all three documents using SOAPS with minor gaps. Synthesizes across at least two documents. Includes relevant outside knowledge. Writing is organized.
4	Proficient. Constructs a clear argument. Analyzes two of three documents using SOAPS. Some synthesis present. Includes some outside knowledge. Writing is adequate.
3	Adequate. States a claim. Analyzes one or two documents with partial SOAPS. Limited synthesis. Minimal outside knowledge. Writing is underdeveloped.
2	Developing. Describes document content without full SOAPS analysis. Claim is vague or implicit. Little synthesis. No meaningful outside knowledge.
1	Beginning. Restates documents without analysis. No argument. No SOAPS. No synthesis.
0	No response or completely off-topic.

Expected evidence and document analysis. DOCUMENT ANALYSIS EXPECTATIONS: Doc 1 — Scranton Commission as Nixon-appointed body condemning Kent State killings; significance of government self-condemnation; Doc 2 — Kerry as veteran/insider witness, VVAW's Dewey Canyon III occasion, Senate audience, purpose to delegitimize the war, significance of veterans as anti-war voice; Doc 3 — Nixon as resigning president, occasion of first-ever presidential resignation, audience as American people, purpose to frame resignation as sacrifice, significance of gap between stated reason (political base) and actual reason (criminal conduct). KEY EVIDENCE EXPECTED: Kent State killings (May 4, 1970) and context of Cambodia invasion announcement; VVAW Winter Soldier Investigation (1971) and Dewey Canyon III; Watergate break-in (June 1972) through resignation (August 1974); Pentagon Papers and New York Times v. United States (1971); Gallup polling on government trust post-Watergate; Church Committee investigations (1975); Campaign Finance Reform (FECA 1974); War Powers Resolution (1973).

Sourcing. Every document above carries its own citation as written in the item record. Verify each against the holding institution before classroom use — an unsourced primary source is worse than a missing one.

History Hack · TroopToTeacher Technologies. Tennessee Academic Standards 2027-28. classroom-formative · pre-field-test — this activity has not been field-tested and its scoring guide is not calibrated.